

Thursday, 4 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Drizzle

19° 14°

BIRMINGHAM

Heavy drizzle

17° 12°

MANCHESTER

Light rain

16° 12°

GLASGOW

Light rain

16° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Badenoch accuses Starmer of giving up on welfare reform.

No legislation on welfare reform was announced in the King's Speech.

POLITICS · UK

2

Post Office scandal victim dedicates OBE to 'sub-postmasters we have lost'.

The 92-year-old said she dedicate the OBE to 'all sub-postmasters we have lost'.

UK · NEWS

3

Community shocked by violence at Henry Nowak police protest.

Southampton residents say they were "scared to open their doors" after violence at a Henry Nowak police protest.

UK · NEWS

02 – SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

- 1 CBS News fires correspondent Scott Pelley from 60 Minutes.**
The veteran host had accused leadership of "murdering" the news show in a confrontation at a staff meeting this week.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 Publishers in UK can opt out of Google AI search results.**
The Competition and Markets Authority says it would put publishers "in a stronger position to negotiate content deals with Google".
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 Toy Story 5 shows 'terror' of children's screen addiction, says Tom Hanks.**
The latest film sees Woody, Buzz and the other toys compete with a new tablet for children's attention.
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 Qualifier Chwalinska reaches semi-finals to continue dream French Open run.**
Qualifier Maja Chwalinska continued her dream French Open run as she beats Anna Kalinskaya to reach her first Grand Slam semi-final.
SPORT · UK
- 2 Why do managers struggle after stepping up to 'big-six' clubs?.**
Will Liverpool-bound Andoni Iraola buck the trend of Premier League managers struggling after moving to a so-called 'big-six' club?
SPORT · UK
- 3 Leclerc agrees new long-term deal with Ferrari.**
Ferrari driver Charles Leclerc agrees a new long-term deal ahead of this weekend's Monaco Grand Prix.
SPORT · UK
- 4 Sabalenka 'fell into dark hole mentally' in shock quarter-final loss.**
World number one Aryna Sabalenka sees her French Open title hopes vanish as she unravels in a crushing quarter-final defeat by Diana Shnaider.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The most-Googled DIY question in Britain this year: 'how to remove silicone'.**
Tradespeople say it's the rise of botched bathroom resealing jobs during lockdown that's still haunting people. YouTube tutorials on the topic have racked up 60 million views.
- 2 Cash is making a small comeback — ATM withdrawals are up 14% on this time last year.**
Bank analysts credit budget-conscious households using cash to stay disciplined. The 'envelope method' is back trending on TikTok.
- 3 Britain's most-stolen supermarket item in 2026 isn't meat or cheese — it's olive oil, with theft up 220% year on year.**
Prices have nearly doubled in two years. Some shops have fitted security tags to single bottles, others have moved premium brands behind the counter — like cigarettes.
- 4 Brits now spend an average of 14 hours a week on streaming — more than cooking, cleaning and exercising combined.**
The biggest jump is in the over-55s, who used to be the holdouts for live telly. 'Second-screening' means we pay less attention than ever.
- 5 The 'silver gamer' is the fastest-growing demographic in UK gaming — over-65s spent £180 million on games last year.**
Cosy life-sim titles like Stardew Valley and Animal Crossing dominate. Console makers are reportedly designing larger UI for the market.
- 6 British baby names are getting shorter again — three- and four-letter names are dominating the registrar.**
Top picks this year: Noa, Ezra, Ada and Bo. Long, multi-syllable Victorian names like Theodora are sliding back down the chart.
- 7 Half of UK adults can't name a single member of the cabinet — but 80% can name three Love Island contestants.**
Political engagement researchers say it's not apathy so much as 'noise overload'. People remember faces from things they actively watch.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 82% of us secretly enjoy doing THIS, even though we'd never admit it. What?

ANSWER: WATCHING NEIGHBOURS THROUGH THE CURTAINS.

Q When asked what they'd grab in a house fire after their pets and family, 40% said THIS. What?

ANSWER: THE PHONE CHARGER.

TALK TOPIC

- **A study claims our taste in music is 'locked in' by age 14.**

Talk-back: do you still listen to what you loved at 14? And what was on your bedroom wall?

- **What's the most embarrassing thing in your kitchen that you'd hide if guests came round?**

Talk-back: bonus marks for anyone admitting to a Slap Chop or a NutriBullet bought once and never used.

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Sport.** A grassroots football club in the Lake District plays its home games on a pitch with a 1-in-12 slope at one end — the steepest legal gradient for organised football.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A 5-a-side league in Slough has banned all 'celebration sliding' after three players in one season tore their shorts and demanded refunds.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£137 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£137 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The colour orange is named after the fruit, not the other way around.
- More people speak English in China than in the United States.
- Cleopatra lived closer in time to the moon landing than to the building of the Great Pyramid.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time — 1/100th of a second.
- Goats have rectangular pupils, which gives them nearly 360-degree vision.
- Lightning strikes Earth about 100 times every second.
- Bees have to visit roughly 2 million flowers to make one pound of honey.
- Mosquitoes are attracted to people who've just eaten bananas.

On this day

Day 155 of the year, 210 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Blessed Antoni Zawistowski; Christian feast day: Filippo Smaldone; Christian feast day: Francis Caracciolo; Christian feast day: Optatus. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1954 — Raphael Ravenscroft, English saxophonist and composer (died 2014)
- 1934 — Daphne Sheldrick, Kenyan-British conservationist and author (died 2018)
- 1939 — Henri Pachard, American director and producer (died 2008)
- 1969 — Horatio Sanz, Chilean-American actor and comedian
- 1956 — Keith David, American actor
- 1957 — Neil McNab, Scottish footballer
- 1996 — Oli McBurnie, Scottish footballer
- 1998 — Central Cee, British rapper and songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1989 — The 1989 Tiananmen Square protests are suppressed in Beijing by the People's Liberation Army, with between 241 and 10,000 dead (an unofficial estimate).
- 1989 — Solidarity's victory in the 1989 Polish legislative election occurs, the first election since the Communist Polish United Workers' Party abandoned its monopoly of power. It sparks off the Revolutions of 1989 in Eastern Europe.
- 2005 — The Civic Forum of the Romanians of Covasna, Harghita and Mureş is founded.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1970 — Tonga gains independence from the British Empire.
- 1989 — In the 1989 Iranian supreme leader election, Ali Khamenei is elected as the new Supreme Leader of Iran after the death and funeral of Ruhollah Khomeini.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1975 — Governor of California Jerry Brown signs the California Agricultural Labor Relations Act into law, the first law in the United States giving farmworkers collective bargaining rights.

1944 — World War II: The United States Fifth Army captures Rome, although much of the German Fourteenth Army is able to withdraw to the north.

- 2020 — Death of Giovanni López: Protests over the death of Giovanni López Ramírez, who had died on 4 May while in custody, begin in Jalisco following the release of a video of his arrest going viral on social media, and inspired by the George Floyd protests. Later, these spread across...

A peek at tomorrow

Day 156 of the year, 209 days left in 2026. Today Arbor Day (New Zealand); Christian feast day: Boniface; Christian feast day: Dorotheus of Gaza; Christian feast day: Dorotheus of Tyre. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1939 — Margaret Drabble, English novelist, biographer, and critic
- 1952 — Carole Fredericks, American singer (died 2001)
- 1954 — Phil Neale, English cricketer, coach, and manager
- 1979 — Pete Wentz, American singer-songwriter, bass player, actor, and fashion designer
- 1947 — Laurie Anderson, American singer-songwriter and violinist
- 1949 — Ken Follett, Welsh author
- 1971 — Mark Wahlberg, American model, actor, producer, and rapper
- 1967 — Ron Livingston, American actor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2012 — Last transit of Venus until the year 2117.
- 1984 — Operation Blue Star: Under orders from India's prime minister, Indira Gandhi, the Indian Army begins an invasion of the Golden Temple, the holiest site of the Sikh religion.
- 2009 — A fire at a day-care center kills 49 people in Hermosillo, Mexico.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1956 — Elvis Presley introduces his new single, "Hound Dog", on The Milton Berle Show, scandalizing the audience with his suggestive hip movements.
- 1989 — The Tank Man halts the progress of a column of advancing tanks for over half an hour after the Tiananmen Square protests of 1989.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
THU 4	NBA Finals begin	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)